

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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THE VOICE OF THE "TURTLE DOVE" CAN BE HEARD IN THE LAND *Song of Solomon 2:12-13*

THE VOICE OF THE TURTLEDOVE AND THE TIME OF SINGING OF BIRDS

Song of Solomon 2:10-13

10 My beloved speaks and says to me, Rise up, my love, my fair one, and come away.

11 For, behold, the winter is past; the rain is over and gone.

12 The flowers appear on the earth; the time of the singing [of birds] has come, and **the voice of the turtledove** is heard in our land.

13 The fig tree puts forth and ripens her green figs, and the vines are in blossom and give forth their fragrance. Arise, my love, my fair one, and come away. AMP

Song of Solomon 2:12-13

12 The blossoms appear in the countryside. The time of singing has come, and **the turtledove's cooing is heard** in our land.

13 The fig tree ripens its figs; the blossoming vines give off their fragrance. Arise, my darling. Come away, my beautiful one. Holman

Song of Solomon 2:10-14

10 My beloved speaks and says to me: "Arise, my love, my beautiful one, and come away,

11 for behold, the winter is past; the rain is over and gone.

12 The flowers appear on the earth, **the time of singing** has come, and **the voice of the turtledove** is heard in our land.

13 The fig tree ripens its figs, and the vines are in blossom; they give forth fragrance. Arise, my love, my beautiful one, and come away.

14 O my dove, in the clefts of the rock, in the crannies of the cliff, let me see your face, let me hear your voice, for your voice is sweet, and your face is lovely. ESV

A Seasonal shift

- ◆ The verse is a vivid picture of **springtime**, with the "winter" of **dormancy being over** and the "season of singing" has arrived.
- ◆ The winter is past, the rains are over & gone, **the time of the singing of the birds** has come, and **the voice of the turtledove** is heard in the land.

Why the Singing and Cooing?

- ◆ The birds & turtledoves are singing and cooing because a time has arrived that brings a new sense of **freedom in the transition from the dormancy of winter** with the pleasurable anticipation of all that springtime gives birth to.

BY IMPLICATION (suggesting)

- ▲ **We also** ought to be singing in those springtime-like moments that we experience in our lives because of what springtime is traditionally known for.
- ◆ **New life, new beginnings, new energy** displayed in **fruitfulness and beauty and smell and blossoming of flowers** that delights.

- ▲ We also should with delight be anticipating those new possibilities and opportunities that the Springtime-seasons-of 'life' brings to us.
- ▲ The ripeness of love.
- ◆ As believers, springtime is also a time when the ripeness of love is seen. At the end of winter and the beginning of spring, which indicates the ripening figs, the fragrance of the vines is also a time when the ripeness of love is seen. The measure of ripeness of us for Christ?
- ▲ Anticipation and Action
- ◆ It represents a time for the relationship we have with our lover (Christ) is to move from anticipation to action, as the season of nature mirrors the readiness of the lovers to move forward together.
- ▲ A dormant state.
- ◆ On a spiritual level, it is interpreted as Christ calling His people OUT of a DORMANT STATE (of winters conditions) INTO a new, fruitful fellowship with Christ.
- ▲ Renewal & Love
- ◆ The voice of the turtledove signifies the arrival of spring, joy, and new beginnings, mirroring the themes of RENEWAL and LOVE found throughout the book. Including the possible renewal of our love for Christ.
- ▲ Fidelity & constancy of love
- ◆ Culturally it symbolizes the constancy and fidelity of love and is associated with peace and purity due to its monogamous nature.
- ◆ And we as believers are called to maintain that fidelity (loyalty and commitment) to our Lord.

In the land

The voice of the turtledove can be heard 'in the land' suggesting that it is more than a mere locality but happening in a much wider realm.

Application.

Beyond my/our personal realm),

Beyond where I am currently positioned spiritually (i.e. my state/condition) and

Beyond my current spiritual growth,

Beyond my present fruitfulness in character and ministry

Beyond my existing love relationship with my Lord.

Arise. Come away; - with me!

By implication (suggesting)

- ▲ At the arrival of spring there comes the CALL and invitation, which is clear, direct and obviously related to those who are intimately known and sharing in a close relationship.
- ◆ The CALL is a beautiful invitation from Christ to rise up out of all those things that wintertime represents dormancy, bareness, and gloominess, etc.
- ◆ To COME - meaning to follow – to be active, not passive – to start doing something that proves our responsiveness to his call.
- ◆ Away from those past negative thought patterns which sought to control our performance, behaviour and actions for God.
- ◆ To come AWAY (with him) in the pathway/journey that he has undertaken to walk in seeking to obey and serve his father.
- ◆ He invites us to accompany him in that journey even though we are unaware of the things that will be encountered along the way.
- ◆ And to fully experience all the different adventurous things that would be a part of journeying (walking) with Christ in his pathway of serving his Father. WOW!

Arise my love and come away!

Come away from what and to what?

To come away from wintertime and all that it represents geographically: COLD, RAIN, DORMANCY, UNPRODUCTIVITY, and little evidence of life and growth.

specifically in relation to the healthiness and strength of love and devotedness to our Lord.

Specifically of our current spiritual state of serving having been exposed to winter's conditions Winter in Israel is a cold and rainy season. It rains quite often, and the snow is rare, but it does happen sometimes.

e.g. Wintertime – and all it represents spiritually.

The time of singing birds and turtledoves in Jerusalem is the springtime, a period of renewal and growth. Amen Ps Barry